



SPONSOR: Sen. Hansen & Rep. Phillips
Sens. Sokola, Wilson; Reps. Burns, Heffernan,
K. Johnson, Lambert, Morrison, Michael Smith

DELAWARE STATE SENATE
153rd GENERAL ASSEMBLY

SENATE BILL NO. 148

AN ACT TO AMEND TITLE 29 OF THE DELAWARE CODE RELATING TO THE DESIGNATION OF A STATE
DRAGONFLY.

1 WHEREAS, dragonflies play a vital role in maintaining the health and balance of the ecosystem as a top insect
2 predator, even though they do not bite or sting humans; and

3 WHEREAS, dragonflies are nonselective and eat anything that flies in their visual field including insects up to
4 their own size, capturing over 95% of the prey they pursue; and

5 WHEREAS, dragonflies are beneficial in balancing prey populations, like mosquitoes and agricultural pests, and
6 they rely on healthy aquatic ecosystems for a large portion of their life cycle; and

7 WHEREAS, dragonflies lay their eggs in water and their larvae live in water, and the only dragonflies in the world
8 that lay their eggs in salt water, Seaside Dragonlets, are abundant in Delaware saltmarshes; and

9 WHEREAS, major threats to dragonflies in Delaware include habitat destruction, introduced predatory fish,
10 agricultural runoff, and use of pesticides; and

11 WHEREAS, dragonflies are Odonates, members of the insect order Odonata, an order of predatory flying insects
12 which also includes damselflies; and

13 WHEREAS, approximately 136 Odonate species can be found in Delaware; and

14 WHEREAS, the Delaware Department of Natural Resources (DNREC) is in the process of finalizing the 2025
15 Delaware Wildlife Action Plan (DEWAP); and

16 WHEREAS, 76 species of dragonflies and damselflies have been included as candidates for the DEWAP list of
17 Species of Greatest Conservation Need; and

18 WHEREAS, the Delaware Dragonfly Project aimed to further the environmental education of Delaware students
19 in all grades throughout the State about the life and habitat of dragonflies in Delaware, specifically studying six species: the
20 Blue Dasher, Blue-Faced Meadowhawk, Calico Pennant, Common Green Darner, Dragonhunter, and Tiger Spiketail; and

21 WHEREAS, nearly 900 students throughout Delaware participated in these activities and voted to designate the
22 Blue Dasher as the official State dragonfly; and

23 WHEREAS, the Blue Dasher is one of the most common and widespread dragonflies, not just in Delaware but
24 across North America, found at almost every body of water and growing 0.98–1.69 inches long; and

25 WHEREAS, Blue Dashers are members of the Skimmer family and live near still, calm bodies of water, such as
26 ponds, marshes, slow-moving waterways, and ditches, in warm areas typically at low elevations, with adult Blue Dashers
27 roosting in trees at night; and

28 WHEREAS, Blue Dashers are often found a long way from water when feeding, hunting small flying insects from
29 perches, keeping still and darting to catch suitable prey when it comes within range; and

30 WHEREAS, as wetlands and other various habitats for dragonflies decrease due to habitat destruction, so do the
31 populations of dragonflies; and

32 WHEREAS, as temperature has a large effect on the evolution of the Blue Dasher's wing coloration, with darker
33 wing coloration helping with thermoregulation, flight performance, and territory securement, and populations in hotter
34 regions tending to lack this darker coloration compared to those present in cooler regions, Blue Dashers are vulnerable to
35 warming climate; and

36 WHEREAS, dragonflies are indicators of a healthy ecosystem and at the forefront of conservation movements;
37 and

38 WHEREAS, the preservation of our waterways is critical to their survival.

39 NOW, THEREFORE:

40 BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF DELAWARE:

41 Section 1. Amend Chapter 33, Title 29 of the Delaware Code by making deletions as shown by strike through and
42 insertions as shown by underline as follows:

43 § 334. State dragonfly.

44 The Blue Dasher (*Pachydiplax longipennis*) is the official dragonfly of the State.

SYNOPSIS

This Act designates the Blue Dasher as the official dragonfly for the State of Delaware.

Author: Senator Hansen